

# What is a plant?

Plants make their own food from the Sun's rays. Most have leaves that reach outward to capture sunlight and roots that dig deep for nutrients and stability.

## Plant parts

There are lots of different plants. But most are made of the same vital parts—roots, stems, leaves, and flowers.

### Stems

Stems support the leaves and flowers and allow water and food to flow from the roots to the leaves.

### Roots

These are the foundations of the plant. They dig deep into the soil, providing stability, as well as sucking up nutrients.



### Water lily

The water lily's flat leaves float on the pond surface, as its roots sink into the pond bed.



### Seaweed

Seaweed looks like a plant, but is an alga. It doesn't have roots, so it has to stick to rocks or float with the tide.



The petals attract insects and birds that collect pollen.

The stamen and carpels form the reproductive organs of a plant.

### Flowers

Flowers are key to plant reproduction. They make pollen and develop seeds and fruit.

### Leaves

These are the work factories of the plant and capture the Sun's energy.

### weird or what?

The Venus flytrap doesn't just get its energy just from the Sun. It also lures and feeds on unsuspecting insects. Yum!